

Practice Paper 2

Fear and courage; love, loyalty and pride · Three hours · 100 marks

PAPER I · 40 MARKS

Answer **all** the questions in Section A. Select **either** I, II **or** III from Section B and answer all the questions given below it.

Paper I · Section A: Poetry, Prose and Drama 30 marks

Read the following extracts and answer all the questions given below them.

I POETRY

I (i) · PRACTICE QUESTION

"He glanced with rapid eyes,
That hurried all abroad -
They looked like frightened Beads, I thought,
He stirred his Velvet Head."

(a) Name the poem from which these lines are taken. Name the poet. 1 mark

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(b) Who is referred to as 'He'? 1 mark

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.....

(c) Name the poetic technique used in the third line. 1 mark

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.....

(d) What do these lines show about the bird's state of mind and the speaker's attitude? 2 marks

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I (ii) · PRACTICE QUESTION

"Not that this troubled him one bit;
in fact, he was quite glad of it,
knowing it's every sane man's mission
to contradict all superstition."

(a) Name the poem from which these lines are taken. Name the poet.

1 mark

(b) Who is referred to as 'him'?

1 mark

(c) What is 'this' that did not trouble him?

1 mark

(d) How do these lines prepare the reader for the poem's humorous ending?

2 marks

II PROSE

II (i) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"Death is a great price to pay for a red rose," cried the Nightingale, "and Life is very dear to all."

(a) Name the text from which these lines are taken. Name the author.

1 mark

(b) To whom is the Nightingale speaking?

1 mark

(c) What price must she pay?

1 mark

(d) What does her final decision show about her?

2 marks

II (ii) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"The jeep rocked. It was floating, the wheels no longer gripping the ground. We kept steadying ourselves on the seats. No one spoke. No one uttered a sound."

(a) Name the text from which these lines are taken. Name the author.

1 mark

(b) Who are 'we'?

1 mark

(c) Why was the jeep floating?

1 mark

(d) Comment on the effect of the short sentences.

2 marks

III DRAMA

III (i) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"Well, now, it's very nice to have got two pieces of the cloth—God bless us!"

(a) Name the play from which these lines are taken. Name the playwright.

1 mark

(b) Who speaks these words?

1 mark

(c) When are they spoken?

1 mark

(d) What impression of the speaker do you get from these words?

2 marks

III (ii) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"You will see, Nicolas, how I can love and forgive.... My love will die out with me, only when this poor heart will cease to beat."

(a) Name the play from which these lines are taken. Name the playwright.

1 mark

(b) Who is the speaker?

1 mark

(c) Who is 'Nicolas', and what is the speaker doing as she says this?

1 mark

(d) Are these words sincere? Give a reason from the play.

2 marks

Paper I • Section B: Novels 10 marks

Select **EITHER** I, II **OR** III and answer all the questions given below it.

I • THE PRINCE AND THE PAUPER

Read the following extract from *The Prince and the Pauper* by Mark Twain and answer all the questions given below it.

"Hendon despatched his ablutions with alacrity, then drew back the other chair and was about to place himself at table, when the boy said, indignantly—

"Forbear! Wouldst sit in the presence of the King?"

This blow staggered Hendon to his foundations. He muttered to himself, "Lo, the poor thing's madness is up with the time! It hath changed with the great change that is come to the realm, and now in fancy is he king! Good lack, I must humour the conceit, too—there is no other way—faith, he would order me to the Tower, else!"

And pleased with this jest, he removed the chair from the table, took his stand behind the King, and proceeded to wait upon him in the courtliest way he was capable of."

(i) When and where does this incident take place?

2 marks

(ii) Why does Hendon decide to 'humour the conceit'?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) despatched his ablutions with alacrity

1 mark

(b) staggered Hendon to his foundations

1 mark

(iv) What does this incident reveal about the characters of Edward and Hendon?

4 marks

II • BRINGING TONY HOME

During a lesson at school, the class has burst into laughter and uproar. The teacher, Mr. Jayakody, is coming towards the narrator, and the boy imagines Tony fighting a garden lizard. He says:

"having broken through classroom order there is no wish to get back to it"

(i) When and where does this scene take place?

2 marks

(ii) Why does the narrator think of Tony at this moment?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) broken through classroom order

1 mark

(b) no wish to get back to it

1 mark

(iv) What does this incident show about the narrator's character and his relationship with Tony? 4 marks

III · THE VENDOR OF SWEETS

Jagan is shown a quiet garden across the river by the bearded man who carves images. They talk about leaving worldly life. Jagan says:

"at some stage in one's life one must uproot oneself from the accustomed surroundings and disappear so that others may continue in peace."

(i) When and where does this conversation take place?

2 marks

(ii) Why does Jagan agree so readily?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) uproot oneself 1 mark

(b) accustomed surroundings

1 mark

(iv) What stage of life does Jagan think of here? Does his retreat seem sincere? Explain.

4 marks

Paper II · Essays 60 marks

PAPER II · 60 MARKS

Answer **four** questions, selecting **one** each from the four sections: Poetry, Drama, Prose and Fiction.

HOW PAPER II ESSAYS ARE MARKED (15 MARKS EACH)

Content 7 · Organisation 4 · Language 4. Examiners reward relevant points from the text, apt quotations, a clear argument that answers the question, and your own sensible response. The points below are a guide, not a fixed list.

POETRY (Answer one question only)

1. "'To the Evening Star' shows both the peace of evening and the dangers of the night."

Discuss.

15 marks

2. How does Wislawa Szymborska create suspense in 'The Terrorist, He's Watching'?

15 marks

3. "In 'Richard Cory' the poet shows that wealth and admiration do not guarantee happiness."

Discuss.

15 marks

4. "In 'Fear', a mother's love is both beautiful and possessive." Discuss.

15 marks

5. "'The Camel's Hump' teaches a serious lesson through humour." Discuss.

15 marks

DRAMA (Answer one question only)

6. Compare and contrast Sodo and Unzu in 'Twilight of a Crane'.

15 marks

7. What is the role of Luka in 'The Bear'?

15 marks

PROSE (Answer one question only)

8. How is the narrator's love for her family revealed in the extract from 'Wave'?

15 marks

9. "Nicholas is the hero of 'The Lumber Room'." Do you agree?

15 marks

10. "In 'The Lahore Attack', humour and friendship help the team to recover." Discuss.

15 marks

11. What is the role of the nature characters (the Lizard, the Butterfly, the Daisy, the Rose-trees and the Oak-tree) in 'The Nightingale and the Rose'?

15 marks

FICTION (Answer one question only)

12. Discuss the importance of Miles Hendon in 'The Prince and the Pauper'.

15 marks

13. "Tony is not just a pet but a true member of the family." Discuss with reference to 'Bringing Tony Home'.

15 marks

14. "Mali is a product of the way he was brought up." Discuss with reference to 'The Vendor of Sweets'.

15 marks

These are original LitHelp practice questions written to the format of the G.C.E. (O/L) 2023(2024) and 2024(2025) papers and the Ministry of Education's 2025(2026) model papers. They are not official past-paper questions. For copyrighted set texts, only short lines are quoted and the situation is described in our own words.